

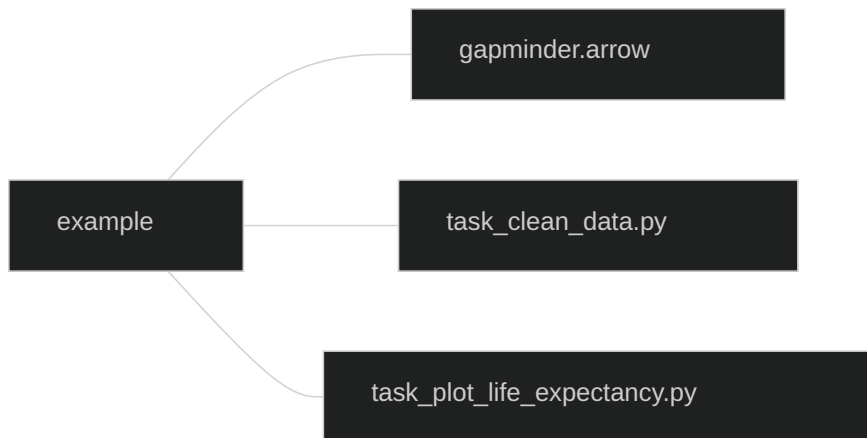
Effective Programming Practices for Economists

Reproducible Research

What does pytask do?

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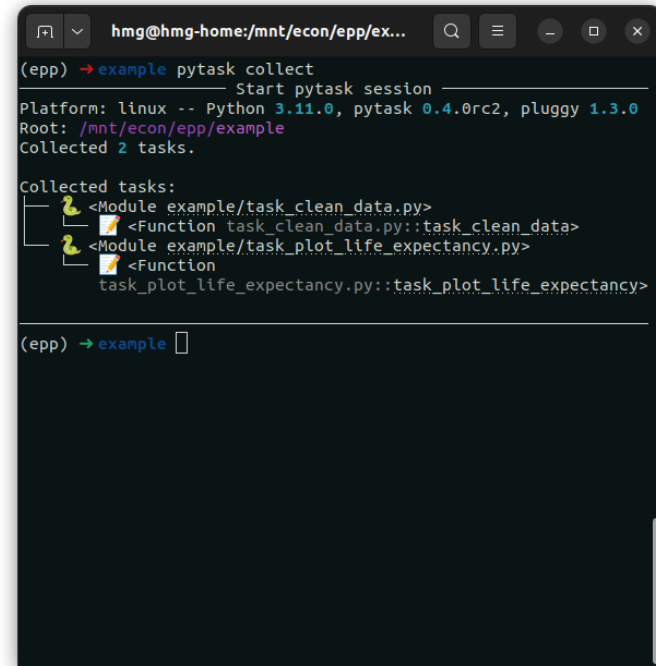
A tiny example project



- `example/task_clean_data.py`
 - Contains the function `task_clean_data`
 - If called, the function reads in `example/gapminder.arrow` and produces `example/bld/data.pkl`
- `example/task_plot_life_expectancy.py`
 - Contains the function `task_plot_life_expectancy`
 - If called, the function reads in `example/bld/data.pkl` and produces `example/bld/life_expectancy.svg`

Step 1: collection

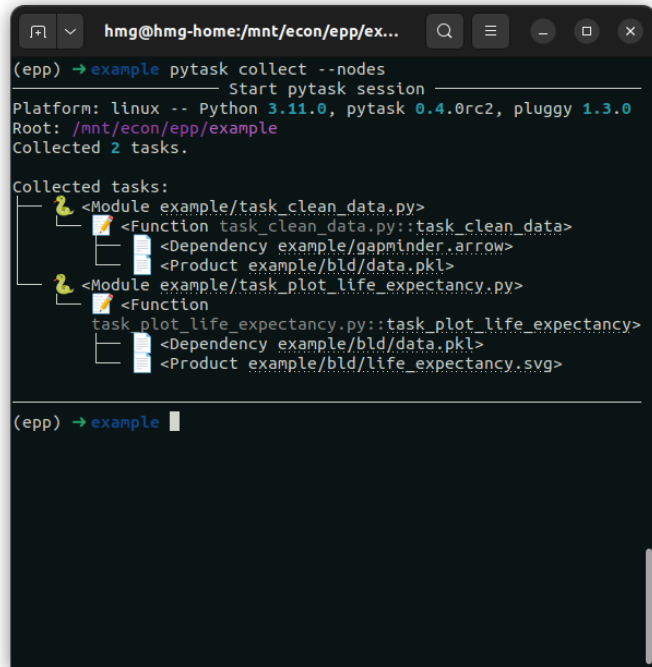
- Go through all folders in working directory
- Collect all files with name `task_XXX.py`
- Go through those files and collect all functions that start with `task_`
- Task functions and their (default) inputs will be used to construct the workflow



```
hmg@hmg-home:/mnt/econ/epp/ex...  
(epp) → example pytask collect  
Start pytask session  
Platform: linux -- Python 3.11.0, pytask 0.4.0rc2, pluggy 1.3.0  
Root: /mnt/econ/epp/example  
Collected 2 tasks.  
  
Collected tasks:  
└─ <Module example/task_clean_data.py>  
   └─ <Function task_clean_data.py::task_clean_data>  
└─ <Module example/task_plot_life_expectancy.py>  
   └─ <Function task_plot_life_expectancy.py::task_plot_life_expectancy>  
  
(epp) → example
```

Step 2: Dependency graph (DAG)

- Inspect function signatures to build a dependency graph
- **produces** describes function output
- Other arguments are function dependencies
- DAG structure enables to determine an order of execution that respects dependency structure (topological sort)

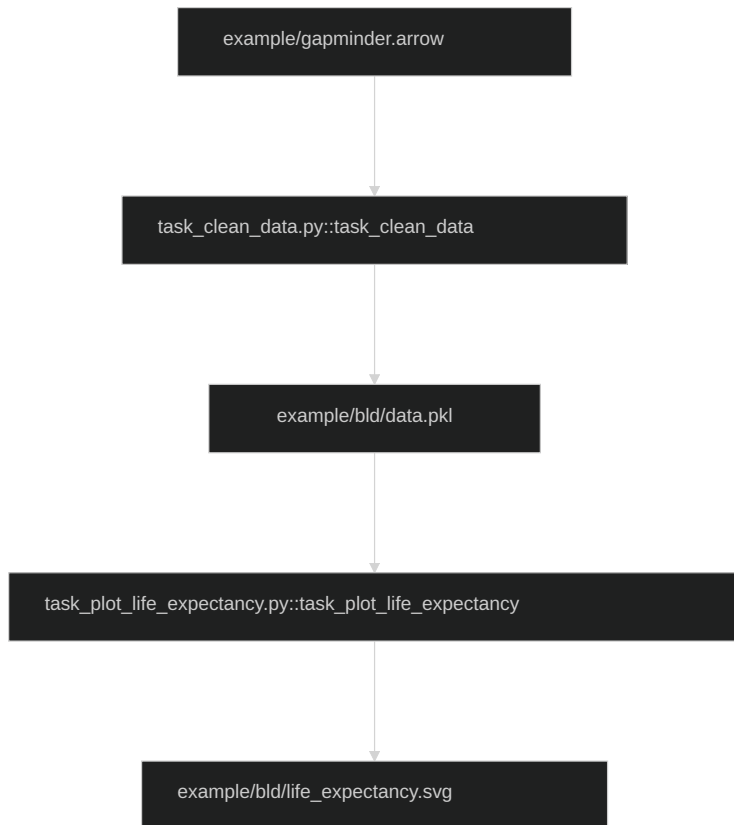
A terminal window with a dark background and light-colored text. The title bar shows the user 'hmg' at 'hmg-home' in the directory '/mnt/econ/epp/ex...'. The prompt is '(epp)'. The user has entered 'example pytask collect --nodes'. The output shows the start of a pytask session on a Linux platform with Python 3.11.0, pytask 0.4.0rc2, and pluggy 1.3.0. The root directory is '/mnt/econ/epp/example'. It reports that 2 tasks were collected. A tree-like structure of 'Collected tasks' is shown, with two modules: 'example/task_clean_data.py' and 'example/task_plot_life_expectancy.py'. Each module contains a function, and each function has a dependency on 'example/bld/data.pkl' and produces a specific output file (e.g., 'example/bld/data.pkl' and 'example/bld/life_expectancy.svg').

```
hmg@hmg-home:/mnt/econ/epp/ex...
(epp) → example pytask collect --nodes
Start pytask session
Platform: linux -- Python 3.11.0, pytask 0.4.0rc2, pluggy 1.3.0
Root: /mnt/econ/epp/example
Collected 2 tasks.

Collected tasks:
├── <Module example/task_clean_data.py>
│   └── <Function task_clean_data.py::task_clean_data>
│       ├── <Dependency example/bld/data.pkl>
│       └── <Product example/bld/data.pkl>
├── <Module example/task_plot_life_expectancy.py>
│   └── <Function task_plot_life_expectancy.py::task_plot_life_expectancy>
│       ├── <Dependency example/bld/data.pkl>
│       └── <Product example/bld/life_expectancy.svg>

(epp) → example
```

Can you see the DAG?

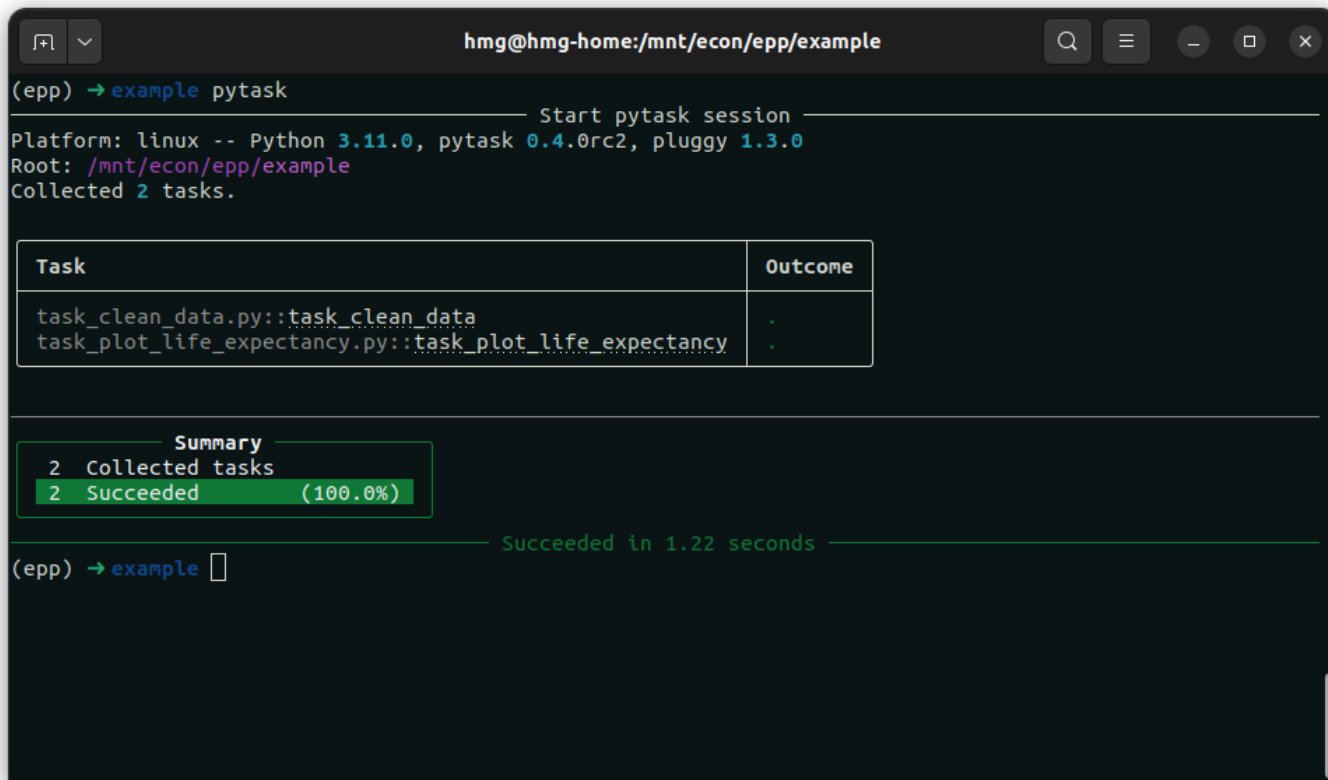


```
hmg@hmg-home:/mnt/econ/epp/ex...  
(epp) → example pytask collect --nodes  
Start pytask session  
Platform: linux -- Python 3.11.0, pytask 0.4.0rc2, pluggy 1.3.0  
Root: /mnt/econ/epp/example  
Collected 2 tasks.  
  
Collected tasks:  
└─ <Module example/task_clean_data.py>  
    └─ <Function task_clean_data.py::task_clean_data>  
        └─ <Dependency example/gapminder.arrow>  
            └─ <Product example/bld/data.pkl>  
└─ <Module example/task_plot_life_expectancy.py>  
    └─ <Function task_plot_life_expectancy.py::task_plot_life_expectancy>  
        └─ <Dependency example/bld/data.pkl>  
            └─ <Product example/bld/life_expectancy.svg>  
  
(epp) → example
```

Step 3: Track changes and execute

- Pytask knows which files should need to be generated
- Also keeps track on when code or products have changed
- Functions are only run if:
 - They have changed
 - A dependency has changed
- Huge time savings in large empirical projects!

Run for the first time



```
hmg@hmg-home:/mnt/econ/epp/example
(epp) → example pytask
----- Start pytask session -----
Platform: linux -- Python 3.11.0, pytask 0.4.0rc2, pluggy 1.3.0
Root: /mnt/econ/epp/example
Collected 2 tasks.



| Task                                                    | Outcome |
|---------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| task_clean_data.py::task_clean_data                     | ✓       |
| task_plot_life_expectancy.py::task_plot_life_expectancy | ✓       |



Summary

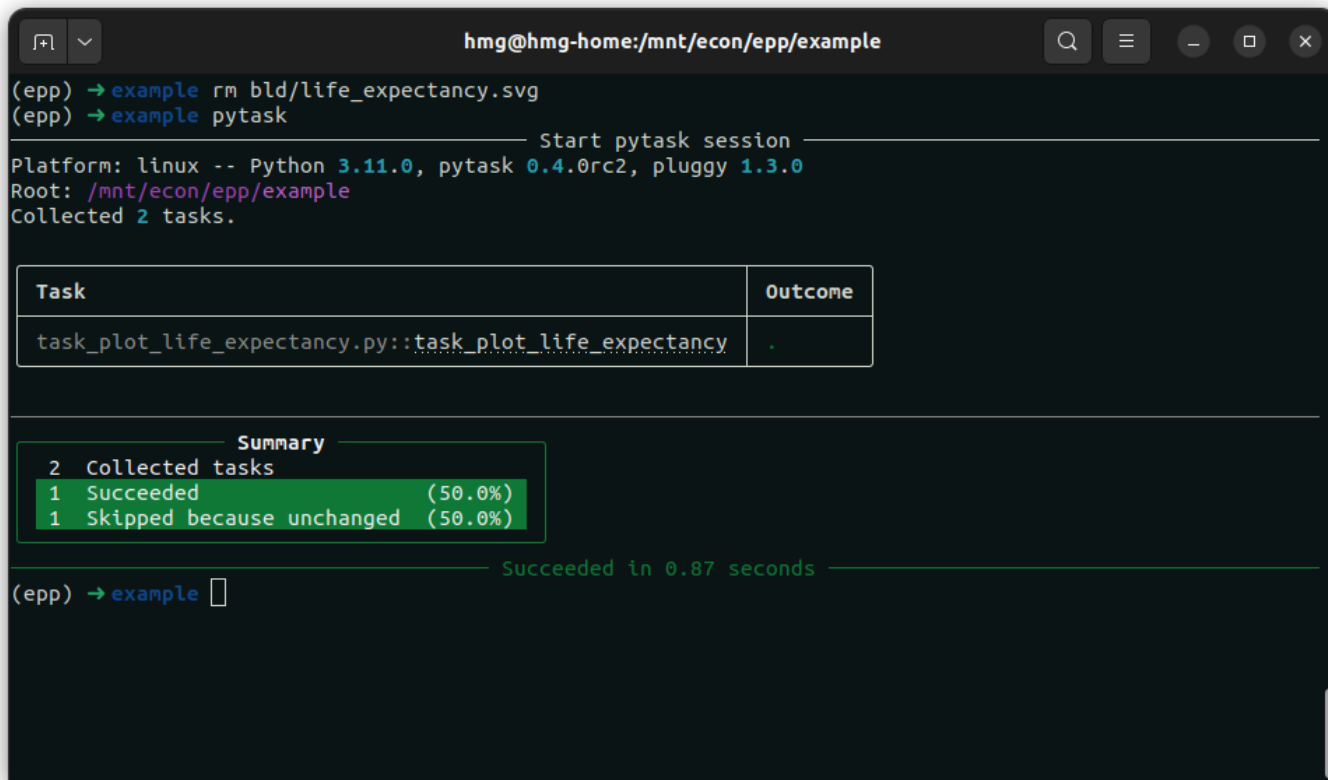


2 Collected tasks
2 Succeeded (100.0%)



----- Succeeded in 1.22 seconds -----
(epp) → example
```

Delete plot and run again



```
hmg@hmg-home:/mnt/econ/epp/example
(epp) → example rm bld/life_expectancy.svg
(epp) → example pytask

----- Start pytask session -----
Platform: linux -- Python 3.11.0, pytask 0.4.0rc2, pluggy 1.3.0
Root: /mnt/econ/epp/example
Collected 2 tasks.



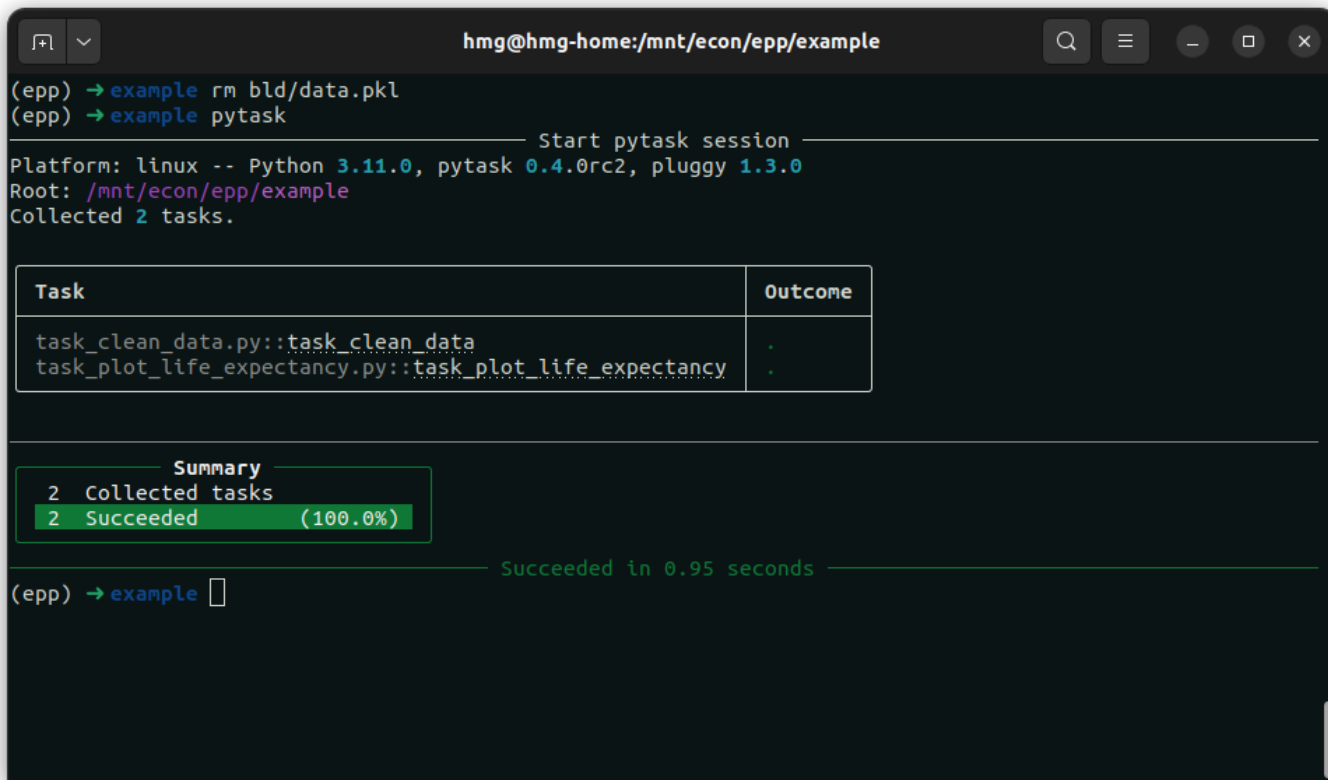
| Task                                                    | Outcome |
|---------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| task_plot_life_expectancy.py::task_plot_life_expectancy | .       |



----- Summary -----
2 Collected tasks
1 Succeeded (50.0%)
1 Skipped because unchanged (50.0%)

----- Succeeded in 0.87 seconds -----
(epp) → example
```


Delete cleaned data and run again



```
hmg@hmg-home:/mnt/econ/epp/example
(epp) → example rm bld/data.pkl
(epp) → example pytask

----- Start pytask session -----
Platform: linux -- Python 3.11.0, pytask 0.4.0rc2, pluggy 1.3.0
Root: /mnt/econ/epp/example
Collected 2 tasks.



| Task                                                    | Outcome |
|---------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| task_clean_data.py::task_clean_data                     | .       |
| task_plot_life_expectancy.py::task_plot_life_expectancy | .       |



----- Summary -----
2 Collected tasks
2 Succeeded (100.0%)

----- Succeeded in 0.95 seconds -----
(epp) → example
```